

The model stores data. The view is responsible for drawing the information from the model in one of perhaps multiple ways. The controller typically creates the model and view objects, handles all user interactions, communicates changes to the model, and tells the view to display the data. This separation makes the overall system highly maintainable and modifiable.

File Display Example

As a good example of the MVC pattern, consider the way files are displayed in the macOS Finder or the Windows File Explorer. Say we have a folder that contains four files and a subfolder. The end user can choose to display these items as a list, as in [Figure 17-1](#).

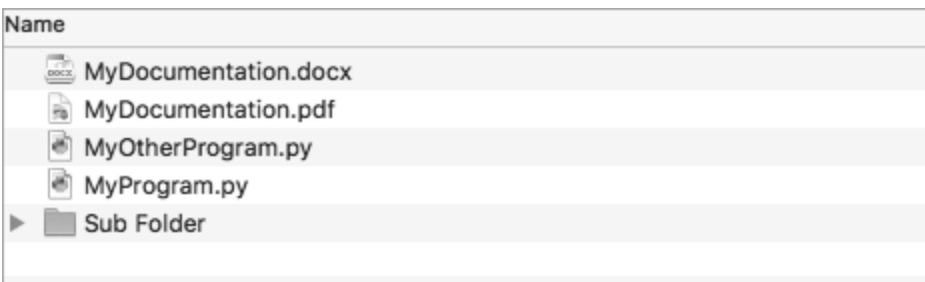


Figure 17-1: Files in a folder shown as a list

Alternatively, the user can choose to display the same items as icons, as in [Figure 17-2](#).

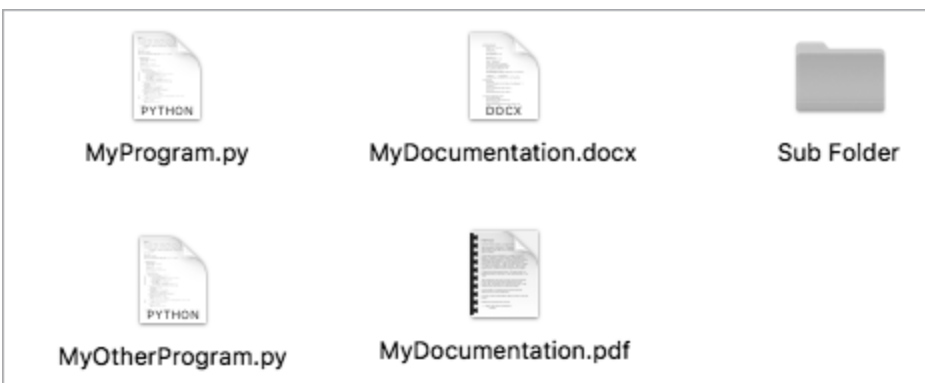


Figure 17-2: Files in a folder shown as icons

The underlying data for both displays is identical, but the representation of the information to the user is different. In this example, the data is the list